

THE
COMMUNICATIONS
AND ELECTRONICS BRANCH

95 CRAFTSMAN BOULEVARD
CFB KINGSTON, ONTARIO, K7K 7B4



BRANCHE
DES COMMUNICATIONS
ET DE L'ÉLECTRONIQUE

95 CRAFTSMAN BOULEVARD
BFC KINGSTON, ONTARIO, K7K 7B4

1000-5 (Br Adjt)

February 2023

BAC Membership

BRANCH ADVISORY COUNCIL
RECORD OF DECISIONS – FRIDAY, 9 DEC 2022

RECORD OF ATTENDANCE

POSITION / APPOINTMENT	RANK & NAME
Chair / Branch Leader	Brigadier-General Dave Yarker
Co-Chair / Branch Advisor	Colonel John Roper
Member / Colonel Commandant	Brigadier-General(Retired) Josée Robidoux
Member / Branch Chief	Chief Warrant Officer Alex Arndt
Member / General Officer	Brigadier-General Pascal Godbout
Member / General Officer	Brigadier-General Patrice Sabourin
Member / General Officer	Brigadier-General Justin Thibert
Member / Strategic A6	Colonel Alan Ferriss
Member / Director Signals	Colonel Dan McKinney
Member / A/Comd CFIOG	Lieutenant-Colonel Gavin Hunt
Member / Home Station Commandant	Lieutenant-Colonel Bahir Ali
Member / STA	Chief Warrant Officer Craig Adamson
Member / Home Station RSM	Chief Warrant Officer Simon Jobin
Secretariat / Branch Adjutant	Major Gavin Ellis
Guest / Subaltern of the Year	Captain Taylor Curran

INTRODUCTORY REMARKS

1. Very brief introductory remarks were provided by the Communications and Electronics (C&E) Branch Executive with discussions quickly moving to the next section of the agenda.

INCOMING BRANCH APPOINTMENTS & INCUMBENTS

2. Captain Taylor Curran, Subaltern of the Year, was introduced by the Branch Advisor. As per Branch Orders Capt Curran will attend the BAC until the next C&E Week. The Member of the Year was deployed at the time of this meeting and will participate in the next BAC.

C&E WEEK 2022/3: AAR AND DISCUSSION

3. Branch Advisor briefed on C&E Week participation of approximately 130-140 individuals and primary AAR points are summarized in Annex A, slide 4:
 - a. Earlier communication of events to the C&E Community;
 - b. Enable participation across Canada;
 - c. Garner participation from junior ranks.
4. Meeting membership highlighted several points of improvement and augmentation:
 - a. Communications and staffing of the event will occur earlier to allow units more planning time;
 - b. Maintaining the virtual options and maintaining the format is recommended to continue building momentum;
 - c. Bringing industry into the event could drive younger members of the Branch to participate in C&E Week;
 - d. Developing working groups to solve problem statements that are important to the Branch and then brief someone of influence could add value to those attending as well as further substantiate attendance at C&E Week as it would represent opportunities to do more than just listen to briefings;
 - e. Level of detail within the schedule was insufficient for supervisors, particularly non-C&E supervisors, to gauge the value for members requesting to participate. C&E week must provide value to the members;
 - f. Explore ways to establish a battle rhythm to the allow for a larger more robust event at predetermined intervals (eg. every third year) allowing for flexibility in the programming that is seen during the week;
 - g. C&E Association events in Ottawa were well received and should continue.

5. What should the BAC provide as guidance to C&E Week organizers as the strategic objective of C&E Week:
 - a. Opening - It is recommended to open the week with key a leaders discussion that will help drive discussions during the follow up workshops;
 - b. Workshops - Call up for workshops would see the Branch membership select what topics to look at;
 - c. Scheduling - Allow for reservists activities over the weekend and looking at how reservists could participate during the week.
 - d. Location – Likely focus on Kingston but develop options for a neutral location or hosting in Ottawa;
 - e. Theme – 120th Anniversary of the Branch in 2023.

ACTION ITEM(s):

6. BAC Membership - What does the BAC want out of C&E week, this will drive: Target audience, themes and where it will take place.
7. Branch Advisor - Identify a reserve representative for the BAC.

MODERNIZATION OF BRANCH COMMUNICATION GUIDANCE

8. The Branch has a communications problem within the Branch for activities, the identity of the Branch, where we want the Branch to go and what we want it to be. The attendees were asked how to improve this aspect of the Branch:
 - a. During the Reserve G6 Conference, the Col Cmdt was told that the reserve component did not identify with the Branch, and it didn't mean anything to them. Conversely, a visit with 33 Sigs Regt showed that troops wanted to be part of the Branch, but they didn't know how to connect with it. How to we bridge these two points of view?
 - b. Unit leadership is in touch with their troops and can communicate Branch ideas to the troops. By providing them with key themes or points it could facilitate the communication of key ideas from Branch leadership down to the lowest levels.
 - c. Proper use of social media could improve outreach to Branch members. Leveraging Twitter, Instagram, Facebook. The Branch could announce significant historical dates, new project delivery or highlight good work done by the C&E Members.
 - d. Change how we tell the story of C&E Branch Members using CMCEN. The BAC could look to redesign CMCEN to move the promotion, deaths and H&R sections to a more secondary function and highlight stories about the people, technology and achievements associated with Branch members.
 - e. Use the stories brought up to the Branch as a driver to inform C&E Week ideas.

9. What are the concrete actions that the BAC needs to develop in order to get better at communicating:
 - a. Capacity needs to be invested through either current resources or through hiring an outside contractor on communication campaigns to deliver the key media lines and messages are desired to be;
 - b. Crowd sourcing of resources through new Branch Members or general volunteers to aid in this challenge. Volunteers are needed as the Branch Office does not have the Capacity to complete these activities in a timely manner.

ACTION ITEM(s):

10. Branch Advisor - Follow up meeting on how to implement a crowd sourced social media campaign.

BRANCH BATTLE-RHYTHM

11. The Branch Office generated slide 6 in Annex A that displayed the standard Branch battle-rhythm that has not changed in many years. It was recognized that the events and activities displayed need to evolve and the Branch Leader has tasked each Senior Advisor to develop a lead a new event. Several examples were given of possible activities, including: distributed video game competition, eSports activity, Cyber Capture the Flag event.

ACTION ITEM(s):

12. Senior Advisors – For the next BAC, develop an event that each could lead going into FY 23-24 that will modernize the Branch battle-rhythm.

BRANCH BUDGET

13. The Branch office developed slides 7 and 8 in Annex A to present a current fiscal update as well as the proposed FY 23-24 budget for the Branch. The FY 22-23 update was provided showing a current balance of \$7,746.68 in the Branch account as of 9 Dec 22. A budget for FY 23-24 was provided indicating that the Branch plans to spend up to \$18,200 in the next fiscal year with \$12,600 being requested from the Foundation.

BRANCH HONOURS & AWARDS

14. The Branch Chief quickly briefed on two Honours and Recognition files that were being developed and that future communiques would include reminders for unit leadership to submit for Branch Awards such as Branch Commendations, bursaries, and other awards.
15. The effort put in by the different chains of command on Branch awards is not insignificant and the Branch needs to ensure that the members being recognized will benefit from the work. As part of the conversation, it was noted that although not an L1 level award, these commendations, and awards to help build bolter the member's file for consideration of future activities. It was also

decided that Branch Commendations would be provided to all members who were determined as the top member or subaltern of their trade. This will be coordinated by the Branch Office.

ACTION ITEM(s):

16. Branch Office – Create and distribute Branch Commendations to members who made the final review board for Member and Subaltern of the Year.

ENVIRONMENTAL BRIEFS / SITREP:

17. **Director Signals (Col McKinney)** – *Slides could not be made public at this time.*

- a. DLCI will be disbanded, Army G6 no longer a Colonel but will now by a post command LCol. Army will stand up a COS Support to cover some previously items that reported to DLCI. Col Mckinney will be the Army Chief Digital Officer, C4ISR think tank for running the army and for operating them. An IOC date of next summer.
- b. CDS asked for an RCCS update – In response, D Sigs has been working with G1 on an entire review of Corp structures and where members are employed. They are also comparing the current talent pool of RCCS members to the civilian equivalent and looking at ways to help maintain talent within the Corps.

18. **RCAF CELE / ATIS (Col Ferriss)** – Briefed the slides found in Annex B with CWO Adamson, highlighted points are:

- a. Battlefield Tour NL 2023 - 3 branch members volunteered to participate and the trades used Canadahelps as donation vehicle to coordination support to these three members. It generated several thousand dollars of funding in a relatively short period of time enabling these members to attend the tour;
- b. A Space Enterprise Study is being undertaken by one CELE LCol to find out where CELE/ATIS can play within that enterprise. It is expected that Space related opportunities will spill over into the prevue of other OAs, particularly the RCCS, as the area of interest expands;
- c. The CELE Mentorship program has been migrated to a MS Teams channel and the OA has held a first “Fireside Chat” with the Captains. Lasting 1.5 hours, it was well received and could be a model for the branch to follow;
- d. 13 new CELE officers have been minted with trade PML at 94%; and
- e. ATIS STA presented the efficiencies being developed in the training of ATIS techs as seen in Strategic A6 Slides 2 and 3 in Annex B.

19. **CFIOG SIG INT / Cyber (LCol Hunt)** – Briefed the slides found in Annex B.

- a. Operational demand is increasing and maturing the capabilities within the formation. This encourages members and puts pressure on the training pipeline. It also enables H&R to properly recognize members for their efforts;
- b. Training and polygraph backlog are being worked on by DGDS as well as CFSCE;

- c. Over next 18 months 50 DP1 Cyber Operator graduates are expected, this will bring relief to the trade but put additional stress on the senior and capable Cyber Operators to mentor and further develop the new members; and
- d. A/Comd attended a meeting with Assistant CMP:
 - 1) Attraction to support trades, CMP would like OAs to become more involved; an
 - 2) Also discussed was training bottle necks at DP2,3 and 4 levels.

OPEN FORUM / ROUND TABLE / QUESTION PERIOD

- 20. Col Cmdt - brought up recruiting of reserve Cyber Operators:
 - a. CFIOG is struggling fill reserve Cyber Operator positions;
 - b. Key issue is the administrative process is broken and tough process to manage and needs to be improved;
 - c. Is there a potential for local reserve units to support this process; and
 - d. The Branch Leader will reach to Col Cmdt to further discuss options.
 - 21. BGen Thibert - Mess Dinner costs are on the rise, the C&E Mess dinner was initially to cost \$120/plate prior to combining the officers and NCMs. The CELE graduation that occurred in November was also over \$100/plate. These prices will impact the junior member numbers in particular, and overall numbers in the long-term. The RCAF Fall Mess Dinner was \$40 for members of the mess.
 - a. Editorial note: The RCAF Fall Officers Mess Dinner was subsidized with \$50 for members of the mess, non-members paid \$90/plate versus \$40/plate by members.
- ACTION ITEM(s):**
- 22. Branch Adjutant – Reach out to RCAF Mess in Ottawa to determine how the latest dinner was coordinated. Coordinate with Kingston messes to determine if lower costs are possible.

Brigadier-General Dave Yarker, CD
Branch Leader

Colonel John Roper, CD
Branch Advisor

Annexes:

Annex A Branch Advisory Counsel Slide Deck
Annex B Senior Advisor Slide Decks

Annex A
1000-5(Br Adj) t
January 2023

ANNEX A: BRANCH ADVISORY COUNSEL SLIDE DECK

BRANCH ADVISORY COUNCIL (BAC)



Friday, 9 1500 December 2022

Slide 1

AGENDA

- ▶ Introductory Remarks (**Branch Leadership**)
- ▶ Branch Introductions (**Branch Advisor**)
- ▶ C&E Week 2022/3: AAR and discussion (**Branch Advisor**):
 - 2022 Participation Numbers
 - Center of Mass
 - Themes
 - Target Audience
- ▶ Modernization: Branch Communication (**Branch Advisor**)
 - ▶ Schedule of 2023 Events
- ▶ Branch Budget(**Branch Adjutant**)
- ▶ Branch Honours & Recognition Update (**Branch Chief**)
- ▶ Reports & Briefings:
 - Advisors (**Director Signals**, **Strategic A6**, and **Commander CFIOG**)
 - NCM Advisory Council (**Branch CWO**)
- ▶ Summation / Round Table / Miscellaneous Points

Slide 2

A - 1/6

INTRODUCTORY REMARKS

- ▶ Colonel Commandant
- ▶ Branch Leader
- ▶ Branch Advisor
- ▶ Branch Chief

Slide 3

C&E Week 2022/3

C&E Week 2022 AAR

1. Participation:

Date	Event	In Person*	MS Teams
October 26	Subalterns & Sergeants Indoc	30	30
October 27	C&E ASSOCIATION PD	40-50	71
October 27	C&E Association AGM	20	36
October 28	C&E Family Update	40-50	89
	TOTAL:	180*	226

2. Primary AAR Points:

- a. Earlier communication of events to the C&E Community
- b. Enable participation across Canada
- c. Garner participation from junior ranks

C&E Week 2023 Way Forward

3. Center of Mass

4. Themes

5. Target Audience

Slide 4

MODERNIZATION: BRANCH COMMUNICATION



Slide 5

C&E Event Schedule Macro Overview 2023



Slide 6

FY 22-23 Update

► Current Balance: \$7,746.68

Funds Expended (Apr - Nov)

- \$540.00 Events
 - \$145.00 Donated to C&E Fund at the Mess Dinner
- \$2,683.60 Trophies & Plaques
- \$447.00 Ceremony & Morale (+\$500 expected)
- \$0.00 Distress Fund
- \$0.00 Educational Bursaries
- \$322.77 CMCEN
- \$62.80 Bank Fees & Miscellaneous (+\$50 expected)
- \$2,965.00 Battlefield Study (+\$550 Expected)

► Estimated Final Balance 31 Mar 23: \$6,646.68

Slide 7

FY 23-24 Draft Budget

- | | |
|----------------------|-------------|
| ► Events | \$4,000.00 |
| ► Trophies & Plaques | \$1,200.00 |
| ► Ceremony & Morale | \$2,000.00 |
| ► Funds | \$9,000.00 |
| ► Office Expenses | \$2,000.00 |
| ► Total | \$18,200.00 |

The Communications and Electronics Branch requested \$12,600.00 from the Foundation for FY23-24.

Slide 8

HONOURS & RECOGNITION: BRANCH CHIEF'S GUIDANCE



Slide 9

Senior Advisors Updates



Director Signals



Strategic A6



Comd CFIOG



STAs

Slide 10

OPEN FORUM ROUND TABLE CLOSING REMARKS



Slide 11

CAN UNCLASSIFIED

Annex B
1000-5(Br Adj)
January 2023

ANNEX B: SENIOR ADVISORS SLIDE DECKS

DIRECTOR SIGNALS

- Slides from Director Signals were not made available for public viewing.

STRATEGIC A6

The slide features a header with three logos: 'AIR POWER IN FORMATION' (with a satellite icon), 'ROYAL CANADIAN AIR FORCE' (with a maple leaf icon), and 'AVIATION ROYALE CANADIENNE' (with a maple leaf icon). Below these is the title 'BAC CELE / ATIS Update' in large blue letters. The main content area is light blue and contains a bulleted list: '• Training', '• Netherlands Tour: Raised roughly \$1500/mbr', '• Space Study', and '• Fireside Chat Series'. The footer is dark blue and contains the following information: on the left, the Canadian flag and 'National Defence' / 'Défense nationale'; in the center, 'Col Allan Ferriss' and 'CELE / ATIS Occupation Advisor' next to a 'CANADIAN ARMED FORCES' logo; on the right, 'CWO Craig Adamson' and 'ATIS Tech Senior Trade Advisor' next to the 'Canada' wordmark.

AIR POWER IN FORMATION
AGILE • INTEGRATED • REACH • POWER

ROYAL CANADIAN AIR FORCE

AVIATION ROYALE CANADIENNE

PUISSANCE AÉRIENNE EN FORMATION
AGILITÉ • INTÉGRATION • PORTÉE • PUISSANCE

BAC CELE / ATIS Update

- Training
- Netherlands Tour: Raised roughly \$1500/mbr
- Space Study
- Fireside Chat Series

National Defence / Défense nationale

Col Allan Ferriss
CELE / ATIS Occupation Advisor

CANADIAN ARMED FORCES
FORCES ARMÉES CANADIENNES

CWO Craig Adamson
ATIS Tech Senior Trade Advisor

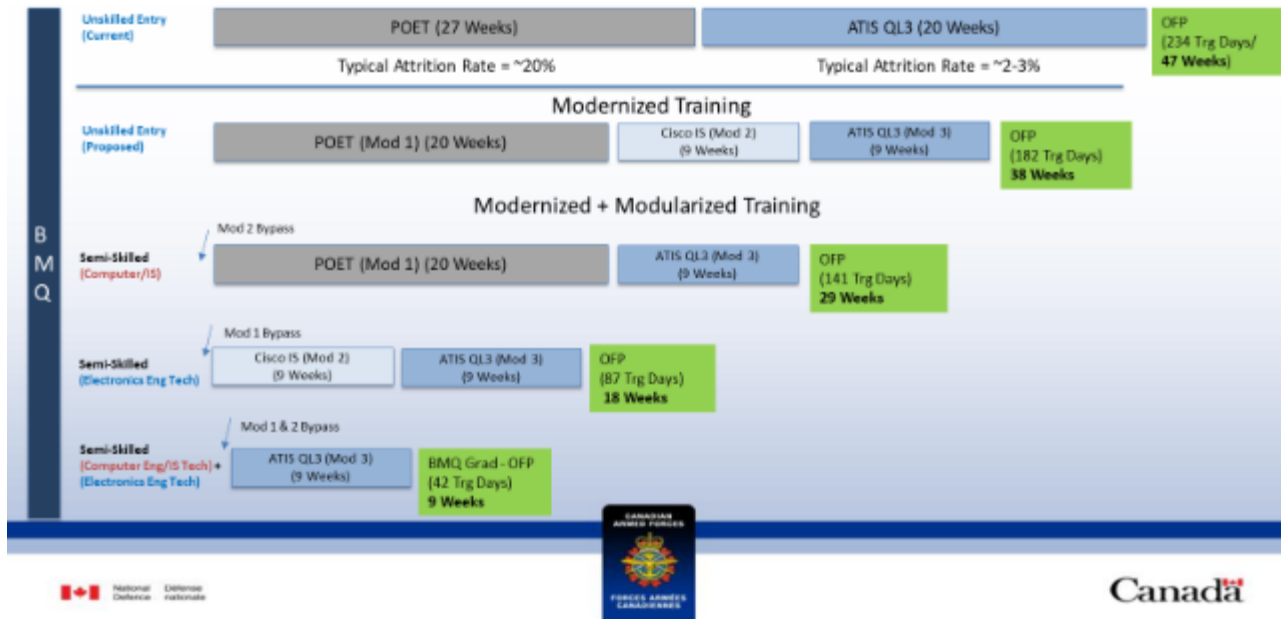
Canada

Strategic A6 Slide 1

B - 1/4

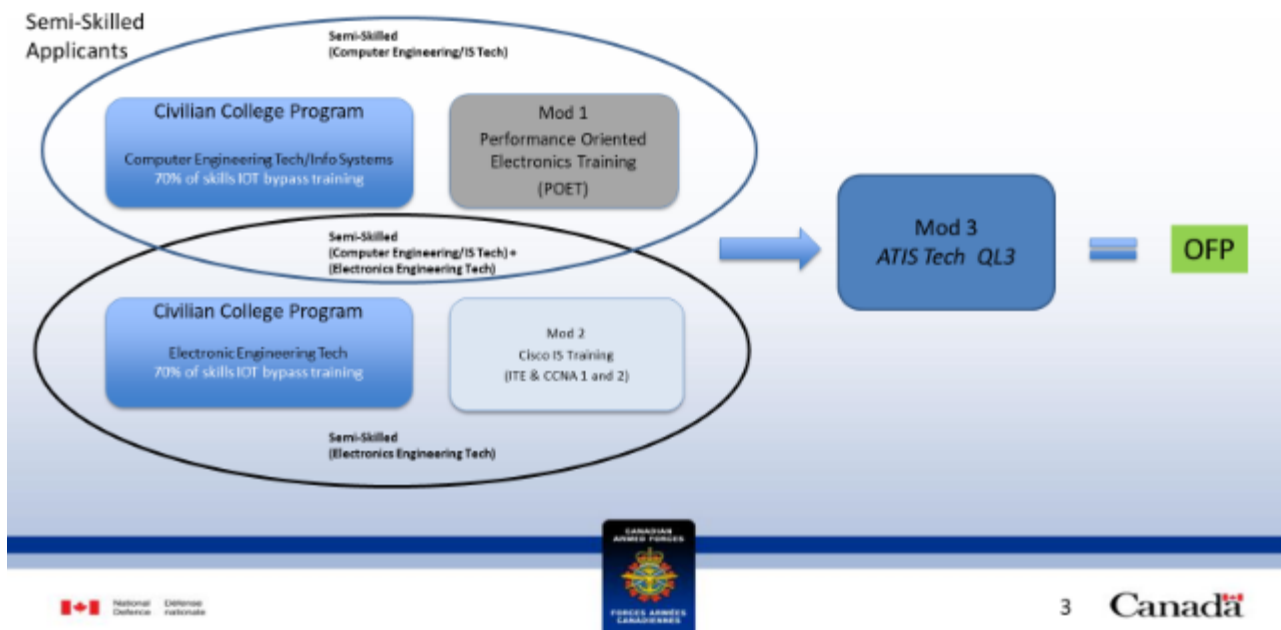
CAN UNCLASSIFIED

ATIS Tech Training Way Forward



Strategic A6 Slide 2

CAF-ACE - ATIS PLAR



Strategic A6 Slide 3

B - 2/4

Comd CFIOG



**Communications
and Electronics Branch**
**Branche des communications
et de l'électronique**

**C&E Branch Update on
SIGINT Specialist and
Cyber Operator Trades**

Occupations Authority: Colonel Corey Crosby
SIGINT Spec Advisor: CPO1 Sherri Jones
Cyber Advisor: CWO Graham Bell

Comd CFIOG Slide 1

Trade Health

	MWO	WO	Sgt	MCpl	Cpl/Pte(T)	Total	
SIGINT SPEC	PML	30	64	128	247	364	738
	TES	27	50	100	169	301	657
	+ / -	-3	-14	-28	-78	-63	-192
	% at Rank	90%	78.12%	78%	68.42%	76.5%	=75.4%

	MWO	WO	Sgt	MCpl	Cpl/Pte(T)	Total	
CYBER OP	PML	3	11	18	32	51	115
	TES	3	8	14	20	36	81
	+ / -	0	-3	-4	-12	-15	-34
	% at Rank	100%	73%	78%	88.4%	63%	70.5%

2

2

Comd CFIOG Slide 2

Update Summary

■ SIGINT Specialists

- Growing demand for operational output
- Security clearances continues to be defining factor for training through-put and integration with partners
- Increasing poly capacity coming online from DGDS

■ Cyber Operators

- Growing demand for operational output
- 51 DP1 graduates expected over the next 18 months
- Pressure on SNCO ranks



3

Comd CFIOG Slide 3

Questions & Discussion



4

Comd CFIOG Slide 4